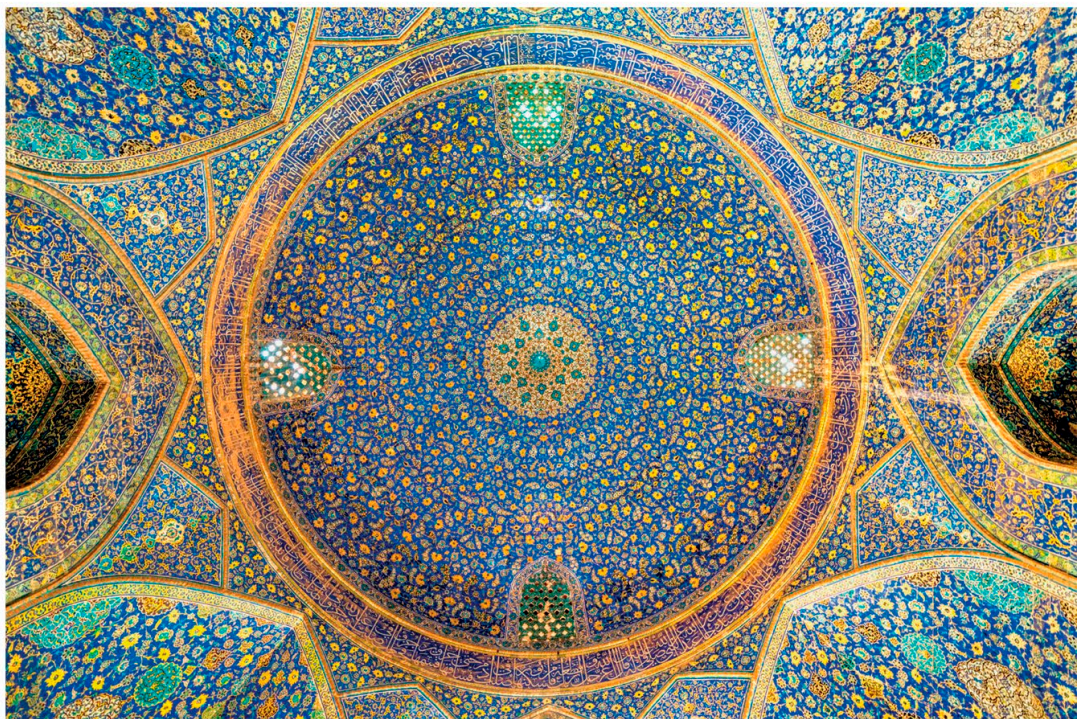


1587

SHAH ABBAS RULES IRAN

The accession of Abbas I, known as “the Great”, to the throne of Iran in 1587 initiated the golden age of the Safavid dynasty. A ruthless warrior, Abbas waged successful wars against the Ottomans and the Uzbeks, expanding the borders of his empire. Persian art flourished under his patronage. He made Isfahan his capital, embellishing the city with buildings of outstanding beauty.

▷ **Ceiling**, Shah Mosque, Isfahan



1580

1582 Pope Gregory XIII replaces the Julian calendar with the more accurate Gregorian

1587 Elizabeth I of England orders the execution of her Catholic cousin Mary

1580 Philip II of Spain annexes Portugal, which loses its independence

1584 Roanoke Island becomes the first (though short-lived) English colony in North America

1588

ELIZABETH DEFIES THE ARMADA

King Philip II of Spain planned to use his army in the Netherlands to invade England. He sent a fleet of 130 ships, the Great Armada, to protect his soldiers crossing the Channel. Inspired by their stalwart queen, Elizabeth I, English mariners harassed the Armada and shepherded it into the North Sea. The invasion was abandoned. Sailing around the British Isles to return to Spain, the Armada lost many ships to bad weather.

▷ **English ships** confront the Spanish Armada

